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ANTI-ICE protesters demonstrate amid tear gas at a “No Kings Day” rally in downtown L.A. on Saturday.

Raids put chill on daily life in bewildered Hawthorne

The immigration crackdown sparks fear, outrage and anxiety in the city, which is now half Latino.

By RUBEN VIVES

The truck carrying two men suspected of living in the country illegally was pinned between a white rusty fence and two Border Patrol vehicles near a busy intersection in Hawthorne. Standing by the passenger door, two federal agents were handcuffing a preg-



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THE SWEEPS have caused some to go into hiding, a Hawthorne man said. Above, ICE agents in L.A.

nant woman, a U.S. citizen, angering the crowd that had gathered there and prompting masked agents to stand guard with less-lethal weapons and batons.

“Let her go, she’s pregnant,” a woman screamed out. “That girl is pregnant, let her go!”

“Get back!” yelled an agent with a steel baton.

“We are back!” a man responded loudly.

The sweep near 120th Street and Hawthorne Boulevard this month was one of several that took place in this working-class city, all part of an immigration enforcement blitz in Southern [See **Hawthorne**, A7]

Trump aims to intensify L.A. sweeps even as ICE vows shift

Agents were told to back off in some labor sectors, but raids continue in cities, sowing confusion.

By HANNAH FRY, GRACE TOOHEY AND RICHARD WINTON

Confusion reigned Monday over the federal immigration crackdown after President Trump vowed to ramp up deportations in Los Angeles and other Democratic cities just days after officials signaled they would stop arresting workers in some economic sectors.

In a Truth Social post, Trump said that officials “must expand efforts to detain and deport Illegal Aliens in America’s largest Cities, such as Los Angeles, Chicago, and New York, where Millions upon Millions of Illegal Aliens reside.” He then cited without proof the claim that those here illegally boost Democratic voter turnout.

It was unclear how the threat squares with a directive last week for immigration officers to pause arrests at farms, restaurants and hotels.

Multiple news organizations said senior Immigration and Customs Enforcement official Tatum King sent an email Thursday saying, “Please hold on all work site enforcement investigations/operations on agriculture (including aquaculture and meat packing plants), restaurants and

operating hotels.”

He added that investigations probing “human trafficking, money laundering, drug smuggling into these industries are OK.”

The Trump administration has not clarified the changes, and immigration actions continued through the weekend.

Since June 6, when immigration agents launched a campaign in Los Angeles to find and capture unauthorized workers at job sites, churches, schools and wherever else they could find them, tension across the city has been palpable.

Stephen Miller, White House deputy chief of staff and the main architect of Trump’s immigration policies, said ICE officers would target at least 3,000 arrests a day, up from about 650 a day during the first five months of Trump’s second term.

But Democratic lawmakers like California Sen. Adam Schiff warn that the plan would “inflame tensions, divide families and stir up more chaos” while placating Trump’s base at the economy’s expense.

“Trump’s extreme policies are tearing the country apart and bad for America,” Schiff wrote in a statement on X.

Sen. Alex Padilla (D-Calif.), who was briefly handcuffed when he attempted to ask a question during a Homeland Security news conference last week, echoed that Trump’s actions have gone too far. “He’s still failing to put forth meaningful solutions for the millions of law-abiding longterm [See **Raids**, A7]

A painful COVID subvariant on the rise in California

Nicknamed ‘Nimbus,’ NB.1.8.1 has been described in Chinese media as producing ‘razor blade throat.’

By RONG-GONG LIN II

COVID-19 appears to be on the rise in some parts of California as a new, highly contagious subvariant — featuring “razor blade throat” symptoms overseas — is becoming increasingly dominant.

Nicknamed “Nimbus,” the new subvariant NB.1.8.1 has been described in news reports in China as having more obvious signs of “razor blade throat” — what patients describe as feeling as if their throats are studded with razor blades.

Although “razor blade throat” may seem like a new term, the description of incredibly painful sore throats associated with COVID-19 has emerged before in the

United States, like having a throat that feels as if it’s covered with shards of glass. But the increased attention to this symptom comes as the Nimbus subvariant has caused surges of COVID-19 in other countries.

“Before Omicron, I think most people presented with the usual loss of taste and smell as the predominant symptom and shortness of breath,” said Dr. Peter Chin-Hong, a UC San Francisco infectious-disease expert. But as COVID has become less likely to require hospitalization, “people are focusing on these other aspects of symptoms,” such as an extraordinarily painful sore throat.

Part of the Omicron family, Nimbus is now one of the most dominant coronavirus subvariants nationally. For the two-week period that ended June 7, Nimbus accounted for an estimated 37% of the nation’s coronavirus samples, now roughly even with the subvariant LP.8.1, probably responsible [See **COVID-19**, A14]



DANIA MAXWELL Los Angeles Times

MATTHEW PERRY was found dead at his Pacific Palisades home Oct. 28, 2023.

Doctor who supplied ketamine to actor Perry will plead guilty

Salvador Plasencia faces up to 40 years in prison

By BRITTNY MEJIA

A physician charged in connection with Matthew Perry’s death has agreed to plead guilty to distributing ketamine to the “Friends”

star, according to a plea agreement filed Monday.

Dr. Salvador Plasencia, known as Dr. P., was one of five people charged last year in the investigation into Perry’s death in October 2023.

Plasencia faces up to 40 years in prison for the four counts of distribution of ketamine.

Plasencia, of Santa Monica, had previously faced a variety of charges, including [See **Perry**, A11]

Fate of homeless programs weighed

L.A. fights proposed receivership for its billion-dollar efforts. Judge could rule soon.

By DOUG SMITH

The question seemed simple enough: Was the witness’ use of the word “makeshift” merely shorthand for “makeshift shelter”?

But for the defendant’s counsel, it was a miscarriage of law: “Objection. Calls for legal conclusion. Calls for expert opinion. Relevance. Lacks foundation,” she interjected, prompting a weary “Overruled” from the judge.

Over two weeks ending earlier this month, more than 2,000 objections punctuated a high-stakes hearing in federal court to have a judge decide whether to take the unprecedented step of seizing control of Los Angeles’ homelessness programs.

U.S. District Judge David O. Carter ordered the parties to file written briefs by Tuesday and then will rule on the petition by a group of business owners, property owners and residents asking him to appoint a receiver over the roughly \$1 billion the city spends addressing homelessness each [See **Receivership**, A8]

Ohtani debuts as a Dodgers pitcher

For complete coverage of Shohei Ohtani’s start, go to the e-paper and **latimes.com**.

Suspect arrested in Minnesota

Vance Boelter stopped at homes of two other lawmakers, prosecutor says. **NATION**, A6

Salary prospects swaying students

Surveys say engineering and computer majors will provide the biggest payoffs. **LEARNING**, A9

Weather

Sunshine.
L.A. Basin: 88/64. **B6**

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